

Shortcut Asia Internship Challenge 2026

Build an app and get hired!

This is your entry to intern at Shortcut Asia. No traditional interviews. Just build an app in two weeks, and walk us through how you built it.

The best part: the project is yours to keep as a portfolio piece.

Update: Due to the large number of applications we've received from the APU Mega Career Fair, we've shortened the build period from two weeks to one week so we can move through selections faster. The new submission deadline is 15 May 2026, 11:59pm.

What you're building toward

This challenge is your path into a paid internship where you work on real software for real clients.

Details

- **Duration:** 3 months (flexible based on your university's requirements)
- **Allowance:** RM2,000/month
- **Arrangement:** On-site (Office near LRT Bangsar)
- **For:** Students in CS, IT, Software Engineering, or related fields
- **Start dates:** July–August 2026 or November 2026–February 2027

The work

Our interns don't fetch coffee. You join a product team and contribute to live client projects, building features, writing tests, shipping code that real users interact with. Past and current intern projects have included work on:

- Banking and fintech platforms
 - E-commerce applications
 - Transport and logistics systems
 - AI-powered product features
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How it works

1. Pick a topic (or propose your own)
 2. Build it in one week
 3. Submit by May 15, 2026, 11:59pm
 4. Get shortlisted
 5. Pitch your product to the team at our office (Date to be confirmed)
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Topics

We've outlined five topics below, but you're not limited to these. If you have a better idea or want to put your own spin on something, go for it. We want to see what excites you.

1. Smart Habit Tracker

A simple app to build and track daily habits with reminders.

Key features:

- Daily streaks and progress tracking with a visual tracker
- Custom reminders per habit

2. Expense Splitter

An app to split bills among friends for meals, trips, or shared costs.

Key features:

- Group expense tracker with multiple users and shared expenses
- Auto-split and balance calculation showing who owes what

3. Campus Task Manager

A lightweight to-do app designed for student life and coursework.

Key features:

- Class-based task categories organised by subject or course
- Due date alerts and reminders for upcoming assignments

4. Peer Feedback Platform

A web app for students to give and receive anonymous feedback in group projects.

Key features:

- Anonymous feedback forms linked to group members
- Feedback summary view with aggregated input per student

5. Simple Booking System

A web app for booking shared resources like meeting rooms, lab equipment, or study pods.

Key features:

- Availability calendar with selectable time slots per resource
 - Booking management with create, edit, and cancel functionality
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What we're looking for

We care about how you think, not just what you build.

Functionality: Does it work? Does it solve the problem it set out to solve?

Code quality: Is your code clean, readable, and reasonably structured? We're not expecting perfection, we're looking for good habits.

Problem-solving: How did you handle edge cases, tricky decisions, or things that didn't go as planned?

Communication: Can you explain what you built, why you made the choices you made, and what you'd improve with more time? This matters as much as the code itself.

Tech stack is your call. Web, mobile, desktop—use whatever you're comfortable with.

Submission requirements

1. **Working application** hosted online or with clear setup instructions so we can run it
2. **Source code:** GitHub repository (public or invite us)
3. **Brief documentation** of your approach, challenges you faced, and how to run the app
4. **Demo video** to show your app in action, walk us through the key decisions

Submit everything through: <https://forms.gle/bTCqepJRpJYqYvkH6>

Timeline

What	When
Build period	8 May–15 May 2026 (1 week)
Open Q&A sessions (15 mins)	11 May: 10:30am & 2:00pm
Submission deadline	15 May 2026, 11:59pm

Ready?

Pick a topic. Start building. Show us what you've got.

Submission deadline: 15 May 2026, 11:59pm

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FAQ

1. Submission Requirements

Q: Do we need to build a new project, or can we submit a previous one?

You must build a new project from scratch.

Q: Who will own the work?

You will have full ownership of everything you build.

This is your project. You're free to use it as a portfolio piece for future applications, continue improving it after the challenge, or even turn it into something bigger.

Q: Do we need to submit both documentation and a working prototype? What exactly should be included?

Yes. You are required to submit both a **functional prototype** and **supporting documentation**.

By the end of the two-week build period, you should have a working product that you can showcase during your demo. Your submission should demonstrate not only *what* you built, but *how* you approached the problem.

Your final submission must include:

1. Functional Prototype

- A working version of your app (PLC/prototype)
- A deployed build if possible (e.g., Vercel, Netlify)

2. Codebase

- A link to your GitHub/GitLab/Bitbucket repo
- Complex logic clearly documented in the repository

3. Demo Video

- A short walkthrough of your app
- **3–5 minutes is recommended**, but not a strict limit

- Focus on features, functionality, and your process

4. Documentation (How in-depth should it be?)

Documentation should be **1–2 pages** and focused on your **thought process**

Suggested elements to include:

- How you planned and approached the app
 - Why you chose certain tools, frameworks, or libraries
 - Your main technical decisions and reasoning
 - 1–2 flowcharts for key feature flows
 - A simple technical architecture overview
 - The tech stack used
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Q: Do we have to follow the suggested topics?

No, the provided topics are just examples. You're free to use them or propose your own idea, as long as it fits the overall theme of the program and can be built within the given timeframe.

Q: Is there a preferred tech stack or framework?/ Is there a required programming language (e.g., Java, Python)?

No strict requirement.

- TypeScript is recommended
 - Use whatever framework or stack you're comfortable with
 - Ensure you can deliver within the timeline
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Q: Are two key features enough?

Yes. Two main key features are sufficient, but you may add more if it strengthens your app and is feasible within the two-week timeframe. Focus on impactful, realistic features rather than overly complex ones.

You are free to enhance your app with:

- Additional key features
 - Better UI/UX
 - Unique selling points
 - Creative ideas
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Q: Can the app be a CLI instead of a GUI?

Yes. Mobile, web, desktop, or **CLI** are all acceptable.

Justify your choice by explaining:

- The use case
 - Who the target user is
 - Why the chosen interface makes sense
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Q: Should we go deeper or broader in functionality?

Go deeper, not broader. Because the timeline is short, it's better to build 2 solid, well-developed features rather than 10 half-baked features

Q: Can we build both a web app and a complementary mobile app?

Yes, as long as you can complete it within the deadline, multiple platforms are allowed.

2. Presentation and Demo

Q: How long should the video demo be?

3–5 minutes would be ideal, but there's no strict limit. Focus on clearly presenting:

- What you built
 - How it works
 - Why you made certain decisions
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Q: Do we need to show our face in the recorded demo?

No, face is optional. A **voice-over** is recommended for clarity.

Q: How do I submit the video?

You may upload your video to:

- YouTube (unlisted), or
- Google Drive

Then share the link in your submission.

3. Evaluation Criteria

Q: What carries the most weight in scoring?

Projects will be judged on three main levels:

1. **Code level**

We'll review your source code for structure, clarity, problem-solving logic, and implementation quality. Submit a GitHub repo and make sure complex logic is documented.

2. **Product level**

We'll assess how well your app functions and whether it solves the chosen problem effectively. Creative and user-centered solutions are encouraged.

3. **Presentation and documentation**

We'll look at how effectively you communicate your ideas. This includes your ability to present the project clearly and your supporting documentation that helps us understand your thinking and execution.

Q: Is the evaluation focused purely on technical functionality, or will UX and design also play a role?

Ultimately, we build products—so functionality is key, and you'll need to show strong technical ability. But usability and the overall user experience are just as important. So yes, we evaluate both the technical side and how well the product works for users.

Q: Will we score higher if we follow the suggested topics?

Not necessarily.

The five topics are examples. You may:

- Build your own topic
- Propose something entirely different
- Choose any idea that you can complete in time

All submissions, whether based on suggested topics or self-proposed ones, are **evaluated the same way**.

Q: Does picking your own topic carry extra weight?

No extra weight. However, **creativity** is one of the evaluation criteria, so unique problem-solving can help you stand out.